AKASH MITTAL

Program & Transformation Lead | Transition, Decommissioning & Data Governance | Banking & Financial Services
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Program and Transformation Lead with 18+ years in Banking & Financial Services, delivering large-scale transition, transformation and regulatory programs from initiation through stabilization. Led delivery governance for the Ulster Bank Withdrawal Programme at NatWest Group, a global technology simplification and application decommissioning initiative covering 1000+ applications. Experienced in core banking migration (Finacle), process improvement and automation, with Scrum Master accreditation and a practical, responsible approach to Generative AI for productivity and decision support.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Program & Project Leadership:** End-to-end delivery, integrated plans, milestones, dependencies, RAID management, resource coordination, committed-deliverable tracking
- **Transition & Transformation:** Transition strategy and readiness, knowledge transfer, process/data migration, cutover and go-live, stabilization, estate rationalization, TOM design, benefits realization
- **Governance & Executive Communication:** Steering committee governance, executive dashboards (JIRA, Power BI), milestone tracking, status/risk/decision reporting to senior leadership
- **Stakeholder & Client Management:** Primary contact for senior Business, Risk, Compliance, Operations and Technology stakeholders; expectation and scope alignment across global teams
- **Risk, Compliance & Change Management:** Regulatory transformation, GDPR-aligned data governance, audit readiness, control frameworks, change impact assessment, escalation management
- **Methodologies & Tools:** Agile/Scrum (Scrum Master), Waterfall, JIRA, Confluence, Planview, Informatica ILM, Power BI, TMMi quality governance
- **Domain & GenAI:** Cards & Payments, ATM systems, Finacle Core Banking, transaction processing and settlement; Microsoft Copilot and Aiden for documentation, analysis and automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vice President – Program Delivery, Business Analysis & Data Governance Lead **Mar 2023 – Jun 2026**
NatWest Group | Ulster Bank Withdrawal Programme (Transformation, Transition & Data Governance)

- Led delivery governance for the Ulster Bank Withdrawal Programme, a large-scale transformation focused on technology stack simplification, application decommissioning, data governance and regulatory compliance.
- Managed program plans, milestones, dependencies and RAID across Business, Technology, Risk, Compliance and Operations teams, driving execution against committed deliverables and timelines.
- Defined and implemented GDPR-aligned record retention codes per Irish (IE) jurisdiction and delivered retention, archival and IPM-based automated destruction for 1000+ applications, enabling defensible data lifecycle management.
- Drove technology estate rationalization, reducing 21,000+ data records to approximately 2,000 high-risk items and accelerating decommissioning and risk reduction.
- Established governance structures, executive dashboards and reporting frameworks that gave senior committees real-time visibility of progress, risks and decisions while sustaining audit readiness and delivery momentum.

Assistant Vice President – Senior Business Analyst & Scrum Master **Nov 2016 – Mar 2023**
NatWest Group | Data Archiving & Application Decommissioning Programs

- Delivered end-to-end data archiving and lifecycle management solutions covering assessment, retention, archival, validation and governance to ensure regulatory compliance and operational integrity.
- Led application decommissioning initiatives, defining retention strategies, validation frameworks and compliance controls to securely retire legacy systems while mitigating business and regulatory risk.
- Served as Scrum Master for cross-functional teams, managing delivery roadmaps, JIRA dashboards and sprint execution, and driving stakeholder engagement and collaboration.
- Established data governance, data quality and control frameworks that improved regulatory adherence, strengthened audit readiness and reduced compliance remediation effort.

Senior Test Analyst – Payments & ATM Systems **Jan 2015 – Oct 2016**
NatWest Group | Payments & ATM Systems (Testing & Requirements)

- Analyzed and translated business and functional requirements for ATM and payment processing systems, aligning business objectives, technology and regulatory needs.
- Led ATM certification and release validation across cross-functional teams, and designed functional, integration and end-to-end test strategies with validation and implementation documentation to strengthen governance and auditability.

Quality Analyst – Test Process Improvement & Controls **Nov 2013 – Dec 2014**

NatWest Group | MAIA / TMMi Assessments

- Conducted enterprise-wide TMMi maturity assessments across testing organizations, identifying capability gaps, operational risks and improvement opportunities.
- Led process improvement and standardization initiatives and established governance and monitoring mechanisms, improving consistency, audit readiness and delivery quality.

Test Analyst **Feb 2011 – Oct 2013**

TSYS Card Tech Services India Pvt. Ltd.

- Supported delivery and quality of a global card and merchant management platform processing Visa, MasterCard and American Express transactions for leading financial institutions.
- Validated end-to-end card lifecycle capabilities (issuance, processing, settlement, rewards, promotions) and executed functional, integration, regression and release validation to minimize production risk.

Software Test Engineer **Nov 2010 – Feb 2011**

Chetu India Pvt. Ltd. | JPay (USA) Financial Services Platform

- Contributed to QA of a multi-service digital payments platform (funds transfer, prepaid debit cards, electronic communications), executing functional, regression and backward compatibility testing and managing the defect lifecycle.

Software Test / Implementation Engineer – Core Banking Migration **Feb 2008 – Oct 2010**

Macreel Systems & Services

- Led implementation and rollout of Finacle Core Banking across multiple bank branches, managing deployment, data migration, cutover planning and post-implementation support with minimal operational disruption.
- Managed and mentored a geographically distributed team of 4–6 engineers, overseeing delivery planning, resource coordination, progress tracking and stakeholder reporting.

CERTIFICATIONS & RECOGNITION

Certifications

- Scrum Master Accredited – International Scrum Institute
- Agile Project Management – Google (Coursera)
- Google AI Essentials – Google (Coursera)
- Generative AI Boot Camp – NSDC
- Fundamentals of Data Governance – Coursera
- Power BI for Beginners – Coursera

Awards & Recognition – NatWest Group

- Living Our Robust Values & Raise the Bar Awards – excellence, ownership and high-performance contribution
- Serving Customer & Working Together LOV Awards (x3) – business performance and collaboration
- STAR & GEM Awards – delivery excellence in the Payments Delivery Program